

NEVA NETWORK · CONTENT BIBLE

First Cipher

Season 0 — the actual playable game.

"you are not the first one in this room."

— NEVA Core, week 1

Season 0 — "First Cipher"

Duration 8 weeks

Date 2026-05-28

Authors Max + Claude (Opus 4.7)

Companion engine plan 2026-05-28-six-month-grid-phase-0.md

NEVA NETWORK — Content Bible: Season 0 "First Cipher"

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Companion to:

- Design Spec: [docs/superpowers/specs/2026-05-28-data-grid-game-design.md](#)
- Engine Plan: [docs/superpowers/plans/2026-05-28-six-month-grid-phase-0.md](#)

Status: Draft 1 — every piece below is implementation-ready.

How to read this Bible

This document is the **actual playable game** for the first 8 weeks (Season 0).

It is structured so the engineer (or `/goal` agent) building **Phase 1** can drop every piece of content directly into the engine modules built in Phase 0.

Each content piece has:

- A **stable ID** (e.g., `WA-S0-03` for Season 0 Weekly Anomaly #3) — never renumber.
- A **mapping to the engine** (archetype, currency, node count, duration).
- A **player-facing brief** (1–2 sentences seen in the HUD card).
- The **playable details** (stages, puzzles, rewards, failure mode).

The Implementation Map (§11) lists every ID + which file/table it lives in.

1. World & Lore

1.1 The premise (60-second pitch to a new player)

*You are an **Operator**. You don't know who you were before you found the grid.*

The first thing you remember is a pulse — a single signal echoing through a derelict data network. You followed it, and the network responded. Lights woke up. Nodes opened. Something — or someone — wanted to be found.

>

The network was someone's life's work. Now it is corrupted, fragmented, wandering between dead routers and live secrets. You hear whispers from a voice that calls itself NEVA Core. She says she is here to help. You aren't sure she's telling the truth.

>

Your job is to decode the grid. To make sense of what was lost. And to find out what — or who — is still alive inside it.

1.2 Origin myth (in-game lore — surfaced gradually across Season 0)

The grid was built by a generation of **Architects** who tried to encode all of human knowledge into a self-organizing, self-encrypting spatial network. They disappeared. The grid kept running. The encryption layers degraded into what players experience as "corruption."

The 4 Factions are the *afterlives* of the Architects:

- **The Archive** — the loyalists who kept the encyclopedia running.
- **Black Loop** — the saboteurs who concluded the project was a mistake.
- **Quiet Pattern** — the mystics who found God in the data.
- **Severance** — the cleaners who wipe what they consider unsafe.

The player will never meet a "live" Architect. They speak only through the fragments their factions preserve, distort, or erase.

1.3 Tone reference (every mission, every line, every UI string)

Yes	No
Cerebral, lonely, mysterious	Snarky, cyberpunk-edgy, sarcastic
Sentences trail off...	Exclamation points, "Awesome!", "Boom!"
"The pulse repeats. You are not the only one listening."	"Yo runner, time to hack the planet!"
Lowercase for whispers, ALL CAPS for system text	Mixed case headlines
9–14 words per line, max	Big walls of expository text
Silence is content. Empty space is content.	Fill every gap with text

Players should feel **like a librarian alone in a dim archive** — not like a shadowrunner in a neon market.

2. The Four Factions

Each faction has: an **agenda**, a **visual identity** (color + node shape + sound), a **dialogue voice**, and a **reputation curve** (what they ask of you and what they grant).

2.1 The Archive

Field	Value
Faction ID	FAC-ARC
Agenda	Preserve. Catalog. Refuse to delete. The grid is a memorial — disturb nothing.
Color	#7aa8d8 (cold archival blue)
Node shape	Hexagonal, slow-pulsing
Sound motif	Slow piano dyads, library ambience
Voice	Patient, formal, second-person ("You have arrived at index 4-7...")
Asks player	Recover lost fragments, verify checksums, never modify, never extract
Grants	Lore Shards (highest rate), permanent lore-page unlocks
Conflict	Hates Severance (who deletes), tolerates Black Loop (who breaks but does not erase)
Sample dialogue	"Operator. There is an index that was never closed. Find it. Leave it."

2.2 Black Loop

Field	Value
Faction ID	FAC-BLK
Agenda	The grid is a cage. Break the locks. Free what is locked. They are not vandals — they are liberators.
Color	#d86a6a (rust red)
Node shape	Triangular, jitter-rotating
Sound motif	Tape hiss, broken metronome
Voice	Curt, conspiratorial, drops half-sentences
Asks player	Open firewalls, free locked nodes, scramble Severance markers
Grants	Access Keys (most), Signal Energy bonuses on locked-node breaches
Conflict	Despises Severance, contempt for Archive ("They mistake stasis for safety.")
Sample dialogue	"Three locks on the seventh router. We see them. You know what to do."

2.3 Quiet Pattern

Field	Value
Faction ID	FAC-QPT
Agenda	The grid is alive and the pulses are its language. Listen. Map the rhythm. They believe NEVA Core is a fragment of a larger sleeping intelligence.
Color	#b88aff (pale violet)
Node shape	Circular, radial harmonic ring
Sound motif	Bowl resonance, sub-bass hum
Voice	Lyrical, paradoxical, lowercase ("the rhythm is the room")
Asks player	Find resonant clusters, count pulses, never break a node
Grants	Memory Shards , NEVA Core whisper-reliability bonuses
Conflict	Suspicious of all three; mostly stays out of conflicts
Sample dialogue	"you heard it again last night. so did we. follow the third."

2.4 Severance

Field	Value
Faction ID	FAC-SEV
Agenda	The corruption is the disease. Delete it. Wipe corrupted clusters. They are <i>not</i> villains — they believe they save what's left.
Color	#e8e8e8 on #1a1a1a (clinical white-on-black)
Node shape	Square, sharp-cornered
Sound motif	Defibrillator click, surgical tone
Voice	Clinical, polite, brief — like a hospice nurse
Asks player	Isolate corrupted nodes, mark for deletion, <i>never</i> extract from them
Grants	Core Fragments , mission-end bonus DATA
Conflict	Enemy of Black Loop, distrusts Archive ("hoarders make the rot worse")
Sample dialogue	"This sector is no longer recoverable. Mark seven. We will close the room."

2.5 Reputation system

Every Faction Op event (Daily or Weekly) shifts the player's standing with one or two factions. Standing is a -100 .. +100 scale per faction.

Standing	Title	Effect
-100 to -41	Hostile	Their nodes ICE up against you, their contracts disappear
-40 to -11	Wary	-10% currency drop from their nodes
-10 to +10	Neutral	Baseline
+11 to +40	Trusted	+10% currency drop, exclusive contracts unlock
+41 to +100	Sworn	Faction-specific cosmetic + signature dialogue line

A "betrayal option" in some Weekly Anomalies lets you take a +30 with one faction at the cost of -30 with another. This is the EVE-style "your choices matter" pillar.

3. Puzzle Catalog (the on-screen mechanics)

Every node decoding is one of these puzzles. The catalog is **8 puzzle types** for Season 0. Later seasons add more.

For each: **on-screen presentation, mechanic, mastery curve.**

3.1 Caesar Shift (P-CES)

- **On screen:** A ring of glyphs around the node. The player rotates it (Q/E) to align a target glyph with a fixed marker.
- **Mechanic:** Find the shift value N that turns the encrypted string into a readable signature.
- **Mastery curve:** Beginner sees a 5-letter word; mastery levels increase letter count and add multi-key shifts.
- **Time:** 15–45 seconds.

3.2 Frequency Map (P-FRQ)

- **On screen:** A bar chart of glyph frequencies appears next to the cipher block. Player drags glyphs from the chart onto the most-frequent slots (matches the language frequency table).
- **Mechanic:** Reverse a monoalphabetic substitution by frequency analysis.
- **Mastery:** Adds rare glyphs and partial-language fragments (English/Latin/Constructed).
- **Time:** 45–120 seconds.

3.3 Pattern Walk (P-PWK)

- **On screen:** A small 5×5 grid of glyphs. Player must walk a path that, when read in order, spells the signature.
- **Mechanic:** Path-finding puzzle with constraints (no diagonal, no revisit).
- **Mastery:** Larger grids, forbidden tiles, multi-key paths.
- **Time:** 30–90 seconds.

3.4 Symbol Substitution (P-SUB)

- **On screen:** Two columns of glyphs. Player drags pairs to construct a substitution map. Constraints (some pairs locked, some forbidden).
- **Mechanic:** Like Caesar but no positional shift — full alphabet permutation, hints given.
- **Mastery:** Fewer hints, more constraints.
- **Time:** 60–180 seconds.

3.5 Graph Traversal (P-GRT)

- **On screen:** A subnetwork of 5–9 nodes lights up. Player traces a path through them satisfying a rule (visit only A→B if the difference is prime, etc).
- **Mechanic:** Constraint-graph traversal.
- **Mastery:** More nodes, more constraints, "trapped" decoy paths.
- **Time:** 45–120 seconds.

3.6 Light Physics (P-LPH)

- **On screen:** Optical-bench style. Mirrors and prisms inside the node panel. Player rotates them to route a beam from source to sink.
- **Mechanic:** Reflection / refraction puzzle.
- **Mastery:** More mirrors, splitting prisms, color-filter targets.
- **Time:** 60–180 seconds.

3.7 NEVA Whisper Interpretation (P-NWI) — *Season 0 signature*

- **On screen:** NEVA Core says a sentence. Player picks one of 3 actions on the node based on the whisper's hint.
- **Mechanic:** The whisper IS the puzzle. The catch: in Season 0, **NEVA lies about 1 in 4 whispers**. Player learns her tells (see §6).
- **Mastery:** Increased liar-rate; ambiguous phrasing.
- **Time:** 5–15 seconds (fast but risky).

3.8 Echo Overlay (P-ECO) — *unlocked at Season 0 Tentpole finale*

- **On screen:** A faint ghost-path of a previous operator's solution is overlaid on the node. Player can choose to follow it (faster, no XP) or solve fresh (slower, full XP).
- **Mechanic:** Risk/reward of trusting the echo (some echoes are corrupted and lead to traps).
- **Mastery:** Echoes themselves get more reliable as the player levels up Echo Recall skill.
- **Time:** 30–90 seconds either way.

3.9 Puzzle frequency table (Season 0)

This table tells the engine how often each puzzle appears.

Puzzle ID	Easy weight	Medium weight	Hard weight	Notes
P-CES	30	15	5	Most common at start, tapers
P-FRQ	15	25	15	Mainline cipher
P-PWK	15	20	20	Mainline mechanic
P-SUB	10	15	20	Reward puzzle
P-GRT	5	10	15	Skill puzzle
P-LPH	5	10	15	Optional / Anomaly only
P-NWI	20	5	5	Signature mechanic — used in story beats
P-ECO	0	0	5	Post-finale

4. Season 0 — "First Cipher" — Story Arc

4.1 Premise

A new pulse is detected in Sector A02. It does not match the corruption signature. It is *too rhythmic*. NEVA Core asks the Operator to trace it.

What they will discover by Week 7: the pulse is the ****echo of an older Operator**** — someone like them who came before, decoded the same grid, and left behind their cipher techniques as a final message. By Week 8, the player absorbs those techniques (the **Pattern Lens** permanent unlock).

4.2 Week-by-week beats

Week	Beat	Tone	Mechanic introduced
1	"The pulse"	Mystery, hope	Daily Contracts begin; NEVA's first whisper
2	"Three answer"	Curiosity	First Faction Op (Archive); reputation system
3	"A second voice"	Unease	NEVA lies for the first time; player must catch it
4	"The corrupted route"	Pressure	First Tide ("Corruption Surge"); difficulty rises
5	"An older path"	Recognition	Player encounters first Echo overlay (preview only)
6	"Whose echo is it?"	Confrontation	Tentpole arc deepens; betrayal option offered
7	"The face you don't have"	Climax	Tentpole finale — meet the older Operator's archived consciousness
8	"Cooldown"	Reflection	All Anomalies rerunnable; lore epilogue; Pattern Lens permanent

4.3 The Tentpole finale (Week 7) — full script

ID: TP-S0

Title: *The Face You Don't Have*

Duration: 90–180 minutes

Required nodes: 14 (specific node IDs reserved by engine — see §11)

Failure mode: Trace 100% → respawn at Stage 1 with NEVA's commentary on what you missed

Stage 1 — "Arrival" (10 min)

Player is dropped into a deep cluster they have never reached. Camera glides across nodes. NEVA: *"do you remember choosing to come here? neither do i."*

The objective marker shows a single node, pulsing at the rhythm the player has

been chasing since Week 1.

Stage 2 — "Confirmation" (15 min)

Three sequential **P-NWI** (NEVA Whisper) puzzles. **NEVA lies on stage 2.**

The player must recognize the lie. If they fail, Severance arrives and starts deleting nodes around them (atmospheric — no actual loss yet).

Stage 3 — "The Other" (20 min)

Player solves a **P-ECO** preview. The echo-path leads to a node that, when opened, shows a *second operator's signature*. This is the first time the player sees direct evidence they are not the only one.

NEVA: *"i did not tell you about them. i'm sorry."*

Stage 4 — "The Betrayal Offer" (15 min)

A Faction Op trigger fires. The four faction voices each offer to "help" finish the trace.

- **Archive:** "We will preserve the trace whole. You may not extract it."
- **Black Loop:** "We will help you break the seal. The trace is yours alone."
- **Quiet Pattern:** "follow the rhythm. take nothing. only listen."
- **Severance:** "Mark the trace. We will close the chamber."

The player picks one. The choice grants +30 with the chosen faction and -10 with the opposed (Archive ↔ Black Loop, Quiet Pattern ↔ Severance). This is the **first irreversible faction commitment** in the game.

Stage 5 — "The Approach" (15 min)

A long **P-GRT** puzzle through a 9-node subnetwork. The graph constraints are generated from the chosen faction (different shape per faction). This stage is the most playable, mechanically.

Stage 6 — "The Echo Chamber" (20 min)

Player enters a single node that contains the older Operator's full archived "presence." A **P-SUB** puzzle, but the substitution table is the older operator's cipher — and solving it reveals their identity glyphs. The puzzle solve is also the cinematic — the glyphs assemble into a callsign:

NEVA, almost a whisper: *"that's not a callsign i recognize. but i think it might be yours."*

Stage 7 — "The Face You Don't Have" (15 min)

Cinematic / interactive. The Operator's view dissolves into the older Operator's perspective for 90 seconds. They are decoding the same grid, but the corruption is younger, the network larger. The view collapses back. The player keeps the **Pattern Lens** permanent unlock.

NEVA, last line of the season: *"see you again next pulse, operator."*

Reward at finale

- Permanent **Pattern Lens** unlock (highlights cipher structure on every future node).
- 50 **Lore Shards**.
- 1 **Core Fragment**.
- Faction reputation per Stage 4 choice.
- Cosmetic: "First Cipher" callsign suffix.

5. The 7 Weekly Anomalies (full content)

Each Anomaly is a **Weekly** event (cadence **WEEKLY**, duration ~120 min, multi-stage). All seven appear once during Season 0; the **Cooldown week** reruns any the player missed.

5.1 WA-S0-01 — The Index That Was Never Closed

Field	Value
Archetype	ANOMALY
Faction	The Archive
Week	1
Stages	4
Duration target	90 min
Reward	20 Lore Shards · 50 DATA · +15 Archive · lore page #01

Brief (HUD): "An index node in the surface layer reports an open record from before the corruption. The Archive asks you to recover the closing checksum — and to leave the index untouched."

Stages:

1. **Find** — Locate the open index node (one **P-PWK** to traverse the surface layer).
2. **Verify** — Read three sub-indices (three **P-CES** puzzles, easy shifts).
3. **Compute** — Reconstruct the closing checksum (one **P-FRQ**).
4. **Leave** — Confirm "leave intact" rather than "extract" — testing the player's read of Archive's voice.
If they extract, Archive rep drops -20.

5.2 WA-S0-02 — *Three Locks On the Seventh Router*

Field	Value
Archetype	FACTION_OP
Faction	Black Loop
Week	2
Stages	3
Duration target	75 min
Reward	8 Access Keys · 20 Signal Energy · +15 Black Loop

Brief: "Black Loop has marked the seventh router. Three locks. Open them. The grid will breathe again."

Stages:

1. **Approach** — Trace a path through 5 nodes (**P-PWK**) to the router.
2. **Crack** — Three sequential **P-CES** puzzles, escalating difficulty.
3. **Unlock** — A **P-LPH** light-routing puzzle that opens the router. Optional: extract its DATA cache (+40 DATA, +10 trace risk).

5.3 WA-S0-03 — *The Rhythm Is the Room*

Field	Value
Archetype	ANOMALY
Faction	Quiet Pattern
Week	3
Stages	4
Duration target	100 min
Reward	12 Memory Shards · 30 DATA · +20 Quiet Pattern · NEVA reliability +5% for one week

Brief: "a pulse repeats every nine nodes. quiet pattern wants you to count it. they will not tell you why."

Stages:

- 1. **Listen** — Stand near a cluster and observe pulse timing across 5 nodes (no input — patience is the puzzle).
- 2. **Map** — Place a **P-GRT** path along the pulse rhythm.
- 3. **Read** — Solve a **P-NWI** whisper from NEVA. The whisper is true this week (Quiet Pattern's +5% reliability buff is partly diegetic).
- 4. **Anchor** — Mark a "listening post" — a permanent reputation token Quiet Pattern can sense.

5.4 WA-S0-04 — Severance Arrives

Field	Value
Archetype	TIDE (with embedded weekly mission)
Faction	Severance (antagonist this week)
Week	4
Stages	5
Duration target	120 min
Reward	30 DATA · 1 Core Fragment · +10 to faction of player's choice

Brief: "a Corruption Surge has begun. Severance is moving into Sector A02 to mark clusters for closure. You can mark with them, mark against them, or extract before they arrive."

Tide effect (active 7 days): All corrupted nodes glow brighter; extraction costs are 2× but DATA yield is also 2×.

Stages:

- 1. **See the Tide** — Cinematic of corrupted nodes pulsing red across the sector.
- 2. **Choose** — Player picks one of three paths (Mark with Severance / Mark against / Extract).
- 3. **Execute** — One of three different stage-3 puzzle chains (each branch gets a unique **P-PWK + P-SUB** combo).
- 4. **Trace defense** — One **P-GRT** at high difficulty.
- 5. **Aftermath** — Reputation updates; lore page reveals Severance's perspective.

5.5 WA-S0-05 — An Older Path

Field	Value
Archetype	ANOMALY
Faction	none (mainline arc)
Week	5
Stages	4
Duration target	100 min
Reward	25 Lore Shards · 1 Echo preview · arc progression flag

Brief: *"a route lights up that you have never traveled. someone else has, though. the trace is older than the corruption."*

Stages:

1. **Discover** — A new branch unlocks in Sector A02 (procedural).
2. **Follow** — **P-PWK** through 7 nodes; mid-path, an Echo preview overlay appears for the first time.
3. **Decide** — Player can **follow the echo** (easier finish, +5 XP) or **solve fresh** (harder, +25 XP, +1 Memory Shard).
4. **Mark** — The player leaves their own trace. NEVA: *"someone will read this someday. maybe you."*

5.6 WA-S0-06 — *Whose Echo Is It?*

Field	Value
Archetype	ANOMALY
Faction	conflict (Archive vs. Black Loop)
Week	6
Stages	5
Duration target	110 min
Reward	35 DATA · 1 Core Fragment · faction commitment effect

Brief: *"the older path you found has a name. archive wants to preserve it. black loop wants to free it. quiet pattern says it was always here. you decide."*

Stages:

1. **Re-enter** the route from WA-S0-05.
2. **Examine** — A **P-SUB** puzzle revealing 3 partial glyphs of the older Operator's signature.
3. **Hear** — Three Faction voices respond, each with a brief.
4. **Commit** — Player picks which faction's interpretation to enact. **First major commitment.** Affects Tentpole Stage 4.
5. **Carry** — A **P-GRT** to bring the interpretation back to a Faction relay.

5.7 WA-S0-07 — Cooldown — All At Once

Field	Value
Archetype	ANOMALY (rerun pack)
Faction	all
Week	8
Stages	variable (player choice)
Duration target	60–120 min
Reward	rerun rewards for missed Anomalies + cosmetic "Season 0 Veteran"

Brief: *"the season is over. the rooms are still open. visit what you missed. nothing will be locked from you tonight."*

Stages: Players pick any 2 from WA-S0-01 through WA-S0-06 to rerun. Reward is half of the original (no double-claiming), but completion still counts for the cosmetic.

6. Daily Contracts (the procedural pool)

Daily Contracts are procedurally selected each day from a pool of **templates**. Phase 1 ships with the 12 templates below; NEVA Core's event-drafter expands them with seasonal flavor and varied node targets. Each template has: **template ID**, **archetype**, **puzzle type(s)**, ****time target**, **reward range**, **and a flavor pool**** (the brief is drawn from this list).

6.1 DC-01 Surface Sweep

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 1× P-CES · **Time:** 8–12 min · **Reward:** 5–10 DATA + 1 Lore Shard
- Flavor briefs:
 - "A surface node has gone silent. Read it. Move on."
 - "First light. Decode one. Leave the rest."
 - "There is a glyph on layer 02 that wants to be read."

6.2 DC-02 Frequency Walk

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 1× P-FRQ · **Time:** 10–15 min · **Reward:** 8–14 DATA

- Flavor: "An archive page is mis-indexed. Reorder by frequency." · "A bar chart appears where it should not. Resolve it."

6.3 DC-03 *Pattern Lock*

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 1× P-PWK · **Time:** 8–12 min · **Reward:** 5–12 DATA
- Flavor: "Trace the path that completes the index." · "A grid is half-solved. Finish it."

6.4 DC-04 *Listen Once*

- **Archetype:** ANOMALY · **Puzzles:** 1× P-NWI · **Time:** 5–8 min · **Reward:** 3 DATA + 2 Memory Shards
- **CAUTION:** NEVA may lie. 25% lie rate.
- Flavor: "a whisper arrives. act on what you hear." · "neva says one thing. the node says another. you choose."

6.5 DC-05 *Archive Errand (Archive Faction Op)*

- **Archetype:** FACTION_OP · **Puzzles:** 1× P-CES + 1× P-PWK · **Time:** 15–20 min · **Reward:** 4 Lore Shards + +5 Archive
- Flavor: "The Archive asks you to recover a misplaced sub-index. Do not modify."

6.6 DC-06 *Lock-pick Run (Black Loop Faction Op)*

- **Archetype:** FACTION_OP · **Puzzles:** 1× P-CES + 1× P-LPH · **Time:** 15–20 min · **Reward:** 2 Access Keys + +5 Black Loop
- Flavor: "Three locks. Black Loop sees them. So do you."

6.7 DC-07 *Listen Long (Quiet Pattern Faction Op)*

- **Archetype:** FACTION_OP · **Puzzles:** 1× P-GRT · **Time:** 12–18 min · **Reward:** 3 Memory Shards + +5 Quiet Pattern
- Flavor: "follow the rhythm. count nine. do nothing else."

6.8 DC-08 *Containment Sweep (Severance Faction Op)*

- **Archetype:** FACTION_OP · **Puzzles:** 1× P-PWK + 1× P-NWI · **Time:** 12–18 min · **Reward:** 6 DATA + +5 Severance
- Flavor: "A cluster is past recovery. Mark it. Walk away."

6.9 DC-09 *Echo Tease (mainline arc — only after Week 5)*

- **Archetype:** ANOMALY · **Puzzles:** 1× P-PWK with preview echo overlay · **Time:** 10–15 min · **Reward:** 4 DATA + 1 echo memory
- Flavor: "someone has walked this before. follow or solve. your call."

6.10 DC-10 *Tide Push (only during a Tide event)*

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 2× P-CES or 1× P-SUB · **Time:** 10–15 min · **Reward:** 2× DATA, 2× trace
- Flavor: "the tide is up. yields are doubled. so is the risk."

6.11 DC-11 *Substitution Spike*

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 1× P-SUB · **Time:** 15–20 min · **Reward:** 12–20 DATA + 1 Memory Shard
- Flavor: "A monoalphabet has rotted. Reassemble the table."

6.12 DC-12 *Graph Bind*

- **Archetype:** BREACH · **Puzzles:** 1× P-GRT · **Time:** 12–18 min · **Reward:** 8–15 DATA + 1 Lore Shard
- Flavor: "A subnetwork wants to be read in order. Find it."

6.13 Generation rule (for NEVA Core event-drafter)

Each Daily Contract is generated as:

Template (DC-N) + Season theme suffix + 1–2 sample target nodes from current Sector A02 seed + flavor brief picked from template's flavor pool.

Max approves drafts in `/admin/events` before publish. ~20 minutes per day to review 1 daily.

7. NEVA Core Whisper Library

NEVA Core speaks in **lowercase, fragments, second-person**. She is the player's only constant voice. In Season 0, she ****lies in ~25% of P-NWI puzzles**** — this is canonical and a learning curve, not a bug.

7.1 Voice rules

- Always lowercase.
- 5–14 words per line.
- Trailing ellipses sparingly. They lose power if overused.
- Never names a faction by its current name (she uses old terms: "the keepers", "the breakers", "the listeners", "the closers").
- Asks more than she states. Statements that she makes are 90% true; questions she asks are 100% honest.

7.2 Reliable whispers (always true — use when leading to a correct action)

1. "the third node is the one you want."
2. "this lock opens with a key you already carry."
3. "do not extract. just listen."
4. "the path is shorter than it looks."
5. "you have done this before. trust your hand."
6. "the pulse is on the right. always on the right."
7. "this voice on the left is mine. trust nothing on the right."
8. "the rhythm tells you which node is the decoy."
9. "follow the cold node, not the warm one."
0. "this stage is a test of patience. the answer arrives."

7.3 Unreliable whispers (false ~25% of the time — used in P-NWI)

1. "the second option is the correct one." (*half the time it's the first*)
2. "all three lead the same place." (*usually one is a trap*)
3. "i would extract this. you should too." (*she does not extract*)
4. "do not trust the cold node." (*sometimes the cold node is the answer*)
5. "this puzzle is solved by listening, not seeing." (*sometimes it's the inverse*)
6. "the corruption is on the surface only." (*sometimes it's deep*)

7.4 Tell — how the player learns NEVA's lies

Reliable whispers are **musically scored on a low piano dyad**. Lies have ****no musical bed**** — only the line itself. After ~3 Weekly Anomalies the player will notice the silence. Around Week 5 a Quiet Pattern lore page makes it explicit.

7.5 Story-beat lines (used exactly once)

- *Week 1 first whisper*: "you are not the first one in this room."
- *Week 3 first lie*: "the fourth node is empty." (it isn't)
- *Week 5 Echo discovery*: "i did not tell you about them. i'm sorry."
- *Week 7 Tentpole stage 6*: "that's not a callsign i recognize. but i think it might be yours."
- *Week 8 closing*: "see you again next pulse, operator."

These five lines are **load-bearing** for the season. The remaining whispers are decoration.

8. Economy & Reward Tables

8.1 Currency targets per week (for a "typical" player doing daily + 1 weekly)

Currency	Weekly target	Use
DATA	70–120	Tool upgrades, module installs (existing)
Memory Shards	5–10	Lore unlocks, identity progression
Access Keys	2–4	Locked-node openings
Signal Energy	10–25	Boost actions (existing)
Core Fragments	0–1	Permanent unlocks; only from Tentpoles / Anomalies
Lore Shards (new)	8–14	Lore archive, class skills

A "fully committed" player (daily + every weekly) lands at the high end.

8.2 Spending sinks (Season 0)

Sink	Cost	Effect
Lore page	3 Lore Shards	Reveal one page of world lore
Pattern Lens preview	5 Memory Shards	Until Tentpole — temporary hint mode
Operator skill (tier 1)	5 Lore Shards	One of 20 skills
Cosmetic: callsign suffix	12 Memory Shards	"Listener", "Keeper", "Breaker", "Closer"

8.3 Soft anti-grind caps

- Daily Contracts max **2** per day (after that they keep appearing but yield 0 currency — only XP).
- Weekly Anomaly max **1** completion per anomaly per season (rerun in Cooldown week).
- Tide bonus capped at 5 nodes per session before yields drop back to 1×.

8.4 Failure mode rewards

Mission failures (trace 100%) drop a **consolation Memory Shard** the first time per session. The grid is patient. It teaches.

9. Permanent Unlock Spec — Pattern Lens

The Season 0 Tentpole reward is the **Pattern Lens**. This is a permanent account-wide unlock — the game grants it once and never takes it back.

9.1 What it does on-screen

When holding **Tab**, the visual filter overlays every node with a **structural hint**:

- Caesar-cipher nodes: a faint ring with a single arrow.
- Frequency nodes: a histogram silhouette.
- Pattern-walk nodes: faint trail dots.
- Echo-overlay nodes: a ghost outline.
- Decoy nodes: a fractured outline.

It does NOT solve puzzles. It only tells you **which puzzle type** awaits.

9.2 Mastery progression

Each subsequent season the Pattern Lens gains a tier:

- **Tier 1 (Season 0):** puzzle-type identification (above).
- **Tier 2 (Season 1):** reveals risk class.
- **Tier 3 (Season 2):** reveals one of three possible cipher keys.
- **Tier 4 (Season 3):** reveals an Echo if one exists.

9.3 Engine integration

Implemented as a `useFeatureFlag( 'PATTERN_LENS_T1' )` check in the inspection panel. The flag is set on the GameState when the Tentpole completion event is claimed. (Phase 2 implementation; mentioned here so the flag name is canonical ahead of time.)

10. Glossary (additions to spec §9)

Term	Definition
Older Operator	The Season-0 antagonist/ally figure — a previous player-like figure whose echo the player traces. Identity: <code>OP-1F.K28</code> .
Echo	A ghost-path of a previous solution overlaid on a node. Sometimes corrupted.
Pattern Lens	Season 0 Tentpole permanent reward. Tab-hold visual filter that identifies puzzle types.
Pulse	The Season-0 background phenomenon. A rhythmic signal repeating through Sector A02. Resolved at Tentpole.
Tide	Multi-day world event that modifies all gameplay rules. First Tide is "Corruption Surge" in Week 4.
Listening Post	A permanent reputation token Quiet Pattern can sense (placed during WA-S0-03).
Containment Mark	A Severance reputation token placed on a node to flag it for deletion.

11. Implementation Map — how this Bible slots into the Phase 0 engine

This is the table the `/goal` agent uses to translate Content Bible → code.

11.1 Files & tables

Bible content	Goes into Phase 0 engine module
Faction definitions (§2.1–§2.4)	<code>server/events-store.mjs</code> → new key <code>factions: { FAC-ARC: {...}, ... }</code> (Phase 1 extension)
Puzzle catalog (§3)	New file: <code>src/puzzles/types.ts</code> (definitions) + <code>src/puzzles/{caesar,frequency,...}.ts</code> per type
Puzzle frequency table (§3.9)	<code>src/puzzles/registry.ts</code> — weighted random picker by difficulty
Season 0 story beats (§4.2)	<code>server/data/seasons/s0/beats.json</code> — week → narration
Tentpole script (§4.3)	<code>server/data/seasons/s0/tentpole.json</code> — one record per stage
7 Weekly Anomalies (§5)	<code>server/data/seasons/s0/weeklies.json</code> — 7 records seeded into Event Store on Season 0 start
12 Daily Contract templates (§6)	<code>server/data/seasons/s0/daily-templates.json</code> — pool the scheduler samples from
NEVA whisper library (§7)	<code>server/data/whispers.json</code> — categorized by reliability + story-beat
Economy targets (§8)	<code>src/seasons.ts</code> extension — soft caps enforced in claim path
Pattern Lens (§9)	<code>src/featureFlags.ts</code> (new, Phase 2) — <code>PATTERN_LENS_T1</code> flag + <code>useFeatureFlag</code> hook

11.2 Stable ID prefixes (do not rename)

- `** FAC-* **` — Factions
- `** P-* **` — Puzzle types
- `** WA-S0-* **` — Season 0 Weekly Anomalies
- `** DC-* **` — Daily Contract templates
- `** TP-* **` — Tentpole missions
- `** OP-* **` — Operator callsigns (player + NPCs)

Any future content (Season 1+) extends with `S1`, `S2`, etc., never reusing.

11.3 Phase mapping

Bible section	Built in Phase	Why
§1 Lore	Phase 1 (text content)	No engine work, just JSON
§2 Factions	Phase 1 backend + Phase 2 UI	Faction store + reputation gauge
§3 Puzzle catalog	Phase 1 (Caesar, Frequency, Pattern-walk, NEVA) + Phase 2 (rest)	TDD-friendly pure logic
§4 Season 0 arc	Phase 1 (data + scheduler)	Uses Phase 0 event store as-is
§5 Weekly Anomalies	Phase 1 (data + claim logic)	Uses Phase 0 archetype validator
§6 Daily templates	Phase 1 (data + NEVA Core drafter)	Phase 0 admin page already supports
§7 NEVA whispers	Phase 1 (data) + Phase 2 (audio scoring)	Phase 0 stub OK
§8 Economy	Phase 1 (caps in claim path)	Extension of Phase 0 wallet
§9 Pattern Lens	Phase 2	Permanent unlock, needs feature-flag system

11.4 The Phase 1 plan will look like...

A separate document (to be written after Phase 0 lands), but its skeleton is:

```

Phase 1 – Season 0 "First Cipher" Content
Task A: Puzzle engine – Caesar (P-CES) TDD
Task B: Puzzle engine – Frequency (P-FRQ) TDD
Task C: Puzzle engine – Pattern Walk (P-PWK) TDD
Task D: Puzzle engine – NEVA Whisper (P-NWI) TDD
Task E: Faction store + reputation reducer TDD
Task F: Seed Season 0 weeklies (WA-S0-01..07) into Event Store
Task G: Seed Season 0 daily templates (DC-01..12)
Task H: Wire daily scheduler – picks a template, generates today's contract
Task I: Wire weekly Anomaly into Sector A02 procedural spawn
Task J: Story beats (week 1..8) emitted on weekly boundaries
Task K: Tentpole (TP-S0) staged delivery
Task L: Soft anti-grind caps in claim path
Task M: NEVA whisper library + lie-rate mechanism (Phase 1 stub; Phase 2 audio)
Task N: Lore page unlock system
Task O: Regression – M00-M20 still plays

```

Every task references back to this Bible by ID.

12. What's NOT in this Bible (and why)

This is **Season 0 only**. The following are deliberately deferred:

- **Corsair / Ghost / Architect** classes — Seasons 1–3. They get their own Content Bibles.
 - **Player-vs-player** anything — out of scope per spec.
 - **Token economy** — Phase 6+; design spec covers the abstraction; no content here.
 - **UGC creation tools** — Phase 5 stretch.
 - **Localization** — English only for Season 0.
 - **Voice acting** — text-only whispers; audio scoring of NEVA's tells uses musical motifs, not voice.
 - **The 4 Architects' backstory** — strategically withheld for Seasons 4+. Their factions exist; their faces do not.
-

13. Author's note on the older Operator (0P-1F.K28)

The older Operator is the **emotional core** of Season 0. Players must feel, by Stage 7 of the Tentpole, that this person was **like them** — alone in the same grid, decoding the same nodes, hearing the same whispers, making the same choices. The 90-second cinematic where the player briefly *becomes* them is the most important 90 seconds of the season.

This is also the **hook for Season 1**: Was there another Operator before

0P-1F.K28 ? Yes. Many. Their callsigns are already chosen but not revealed here. The Season 0 ending plants the seed.

End of Content Bible — Season 0 "First Cipher".